

TYPES OF SENTENCES

Simple Sentence

Compound Sentence

Complex Sentence

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What is a Sentence?

A sentence is a group of words that gives a **COMPLETE THOUGHT**.



Every sentence needs a **SUBJECT** (who/what) and a **VERB** (action/state).

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A sentence **starts** with a **CAPITAL** letter and **ends** with a **FULL STOP, ? or !**



It must express a complete idea — not leave the reader wondering.

Three Types of Sentences

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Simple Sentence

ONE independent clause — one subject + one verb

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TWO or more independent clauses joined by a conjunction (and, but, or, so...)

"She sings and he dances."

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"She sings and he dances."

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Complex Sentence

ONE independent clause + ONE or more dependent clauses

"She sings because she is happy."

Simple Sentence

A simple sentence has ONE independent clause with ONE main subject and ONE main verb.

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Examples:

The sun rises in the east.

*Subject: **The sun** / Verb: **rises***

Ravi plays cricket every evening.

*Subject: **Ravi** / Verb: **plays***

My mother cooks delicious food.

*Subject: **My mother** / Verb: **cooks***

Birds fly in the sky.

*Subject: **Birds** / Verb: **fly***

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Subject: *Ravi* | Verb: *plays*

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💡 ***A simple sentence can have a COMPOUND subject or verb — it is still simple!***

Simple Sentence — Still Simple!

A simple sentence remains simple even with:

Compound Subject (2 subjects, 1 verb)

***Ram AND Sita** went to the market.*

→ *Two subjects — ONE verb* → still SIMPLE

Simple Sentence — Still Simple!

A simple sentence remains simple even with:

Compound Subject (2 subjects, 1 verb)

Ram AND Sita went to the market.

→ Two subjects — ONE verb → still SIMPLE

Compound Verb (1 subject, 2 verbs)

She sang AND danced at the party.

→ One subject — two verbs → still SIMPLE

Simple Sentence — Still Simple!

A simple sentence remains simple even with:

Compound Subject (2 subjects, 1 verb)

Ram AND Sita went to the market.

→ Two subjects — ONE verb → still SIMPLE

Compound Verb (1 subject, 2 verbs)

She sang AND danced at the party.

→ One subject — two verbs → still SIMPLE

KEY RULE: Count the **NUMBER OF INDEPENDENT CLAUSES** — not subjects or verbs — to identify sentence type.

Compound Sentence

A compound sentence joins TWO or more independent clauses using a coordinating conjunction (FANBOYS) or a semicolon (;).

FANBOYS — Coordinating Conjunctions:

F for

(because)

A and

(addition)

N nor

(neither)

B but

(contrast)

O or

(choice)

Y yet

(contrast)

S so

(result)

Examples:

She was tired, **but** she kept studying.

I like cricket, **and** my friend likes football.

FANBOYS

FANBOYS is an acronym for the seven coordinating conjunctions:

For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So.

They connect words, phrases, or independent clauses (complete thoughts) of equal importance.

FANBOYS

The Comma Rule

When a FANBOYS word joins two complete sentences (independent clauses), place a comma directly before it.

- Example:** I wanted to go to the park, so I packed a lunch.
- No comma:** I wanted to go to the park and rest. (No comma needed because the second part isn't a complete sentence).

FANBOYS

For: Explains reason or purpose (means *because*).

Example: I stayed indoors, **f**or it was raining.

And: Joins related ideas or items.

Example: She likes coffee, **a**nd she drinks it every morning.

Nor: Presents a negative alternative.

Example: He does not like apples, **n**or does he like oranges.

FANBOYS

But: Shows contrast or exception.

Example: The car is old, **but** it runs perfectly.

Or: Presents a choice or option.

Example: You can have tea, **or** you can have coffee.

FANBOYS

Yet: Shows a surprising contrast.

Example: It was late, **y**et we were wide awake.

So: Indicates a result or consequence.

Example: The store was closed, **s**o I went home.

COMPOUND SENTENCE WITH SEMICOLON

- I am going home; I intend to stay there.
- The results were late; we adjusted the schedule.
- The traffic has been terrible lately; maybe you should fly instead.

Complex Sentence

A complex sentence has ONE independent clause + at least ONE dependent clause, joined by a subordinating conjunction.

Common Subordinating Conjunctions:

because

since

although

though

if

unless

when

after

before

until

while

as soon as

Examples — independent clause / dependent clause:

I study hard *because I want good marks.*

Although it was raining, we played cricket.

She left *before the bell rang.*

Comparison — All Three Types

	Simple	Compound	Complex
No. of Clauses	1 Independent Clause	2 Independent Clauses	1 Independent + 1 Dependent
Conjunction	None	FANBOYS / ;	Subordinating conjunction
Note	Short & clear	Equal ideas joined	One idea depends on other
Example	<i>She reads books.</i>	<i>She reads books, and he watches TV.</i>	<i>She reads books because she loves learning.</i>

How to Identify the Sentence Type

STEP 1

Find all the VERBS in the sentence.

Each verb (usually) belongs to a separate clause.

STEP 2

Identify each CLAUSE (subject + verb group).

Count how many clauses can stand alone as a sentence.

STEP 3

Look for CONJUNCTIONS.

FANBOYS (and/but/or...) → Compound | Because/when/if... → Complex | No conjunction → Simple

STEP 4

Apply the rule.

1 clause = Simple | 2+ independent = Compound | Independent + Dependent = Complex

Let's Practise — Spot the Type!

1. The dog barked loudly.

▶ Simple

2. I was tired, so I slept early.

▶ Compound

3. She cried when she heard the news.

▶ Complex

4. Anu and Minu study together and help each other.

▶ Simple

5. Although he was sick, he attended class.

▶ Complex

1. Identify the type of sentence:
"The cat sat on the mat."

A Compound Sentence

B Complex Sentence

C Simple Sentence

D None of these

Answer — Question 1

1. Identify the type of sentence:
"The cat sat on the mat."

✓ **CORRECT ANSWER: C) Simple Sentence**

Explanation:

"The cat sat on the mat" has ONE subject (the cat) and ONE verb (sat). It forms one independent clause with a complete thought. That makes it a Simple Sentence.

2. Which sentence is a **COMPOUND** sentence?

A She sings beautifully.

B I was hungry, so I ate rice.

C Although he was late, he came.

D The boy who won is smart.

Answer — Question 2

2. Which sentence is a **COMPOUND** sentence?



CORRECT ANSWER: B) I was hungry, so I ate rice.



Explanation:

"I was hungry" and "I ate rice" are both independent clauses joined by the coordinating conjunction 'so'. Two independent clauses joined by a FANBOYS conjunction = Compound Sentence.

3. "She left the room BECAUSE she was angry."
This sentence is:

A Simple

B Compound

C Complex

D Compound-Complex

Answer — Question 3

3. "She left the room **BECAUSE** she was angry."

This sentence is:



CORRECT ANSWER: C) Complex



Explanation:

"She left the room" is the independent clause. "Because she was angry" is a dependent clause — it cannot stand alone. The subordinating conjunction 'because' joins them. Independent + Dependent = Complex Sentence.

4. "Ram and Shyam play football every day."
What type of sentence is this?

A Complex

B Compound

C Compound-Complex

D Simple

Answer — Question 4

4. "Ram and Shyam play football every day."
What type of sentence is this?



CORRECT ANSWER: D) Simple



Explanation:

There is only ONE verb (play) and the sentence forms ONE independent clause. 'Ram and Shyam' is a compound subject — but having two subjects does NOT make it compound. Only one independent clause → Simple Sentence.

5. Choose the **COMPLEX** sentence from the options below.

A I like tea and she likes coffee.

B He runs fast.

C I will help you if you ask me.

D She sang and danced.

Answer — Question 5

5. Choose the **COMPLEX** sentence from the options below.



CORRECT ANSWER: C) I will help you if you ask me.

Explanation:

"I will help you" (independent) + "if you ask me" (dependent clause). The subordinating conjunction 'if' introduces the dependent clause. This combination — independent + dependent — is the definition of a Complex Sentence.

6. "It was raining heavily, BUT we played cricket."
Identify the conjunction and sentence type.

A 'but' — Complex Sentence

B 'but' — Compound Sentence

C 'but' — Simple Sentence

D No conjunction — Simple Sentence

Answer — Question 6

6. "It was raining heavily, BUT we played cricket."
Identify the conjunction and sentence type.

✓ **CORRECT ANSWER: B) 'but' — Compound Sentence**

Explanation:

'But' is a coordinating conjunction (part of FANBOYS). It joins two independent clauses: "It was raining heavily" and "we played cricket". Two independent clauses + coordinating conjunction = Compound Sentence.

7. How many independent clauses are in a SIMPLE sentence?

A Zero

B One

C Two

D Three or more

Answer — Question 7

7. How many independent clauses are in a SIMPLE sentence?



CORRECT ANSWER: B) One

Explanation:

A simple sentence contains exactly ONE independent clause. It may have a compound subject or a compound verb, but there is only ONE main subject-verb group that expresses one complete thought.

8. "ALTHOUGH she studied hard, she failed the exam."

The underlined part is:

A An independent clause

B A dependent clause

C A compound sentence

D A simple sentence

Answer — Question 8

8. "ALTHOUGH she studied hard, she failed the exam."

The underlined part is:



CORRECT ANSWER: B) A dependent clause



Explanation:

"Although she studied hard" begins with the subordinating conjunction 'although'. It cannot stand alone — we still wonder what happened. It depends on "she failed the exam" to complete the meaning. That makes it a Dependent Clause.

9. Which word below is NOT a coordinating conjunction (FANBOYS)?

A and

B but

C because

D so

Answer — Question 9

9. Which word below is NOT a coordinating conjunction (FANBOYS)?

✓ **CORRECT ANSWER: C) because**

Explanation:

'Because' is a SUBORDINATING conjunction — it introduces a dependent clause in a complex sentence. FANBOYS stands for For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So. 'Because' is not in this list; it belongs to the group of subordinating conjunctions.

10. "I read the book; it was very interesting."
This is an example of a:

A Simple sentence

B Complex sentence

C Compound sentence using a semicolon

D Sentence fragment

Answer — Question 10

10. "I read the book; it was very interesting."

This is an example of a:



CORRECT ANSWER: C) Compound sentence using a semicolon



Explanation:

"I read the book" and "it was very interesting" are both independent clauses that can stand alone. A semicolon (;) can replace a coordinating conjunction to join two independent clauses. This gives us a Compound Sentence.

Summary — What You Learned!

- ❓ A SIMPLE sentence has ONE independent clause (one subject + one verb).
- ❓ A COMPOUND sentence joins two independent clauses with FANBOYS (and, but, or, so...) or a semicolon.
- ❓ A COMPLEX sentence has one independent clause + one dependent clause joined by a subordinating conjunction.
- 🔑 Count the CLAUSES — not just subjects or verbs — to identify the sentence type.
- 📌 FANBOYS conjunctions → Compound | because/if/when/although → Complex